

Activity 1 Prompting Patterns for Project Managers

Activity 1 | Topic 01 | C013 | Version v1.0

Course: Generative AI for Project Management (C013) Topic 01: Project Initiation and Planning with GenAI Learning outcome: LO1 - Apply structured prompting patterns to produce usable project management output. Tools: ChatGPT | Claude | Gemini | Copilot | Project Manager Buddy GPT

Goal

Work through the ten prompting patterns on a project of your own. You will see the same question answered badly by a vague prompt and well by a structured one, and you will keep a personal prompt library for the rest of the course.

What you'll produce

A personal prompt library of 10 tested prompts, each with the output it produced and your critique.

Activity files

- [Activity guide PDF](./activity-guide.pdf)
- [Prompt sheet](./prompts.pdf)
- [Detailed instruction manual](./instruction-manual.pdf)
- [Mock data workbook](./mock-data.xlsx)

Core prompt

Act as a stakeholder of the project. Perform an assessment of the project charter and provide a list of

Step-by-step

1. Open your preferred GenAI tool (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini or Copilot) and sign in. Open the Project Manager Buddy GPT in a second tab: <https://chatgpt.com/g/g-hUcEmp6Rp-project-manager-buddy-project-management>
2. Choose a real project from your own workplace - one you know well enough to judge whether the AI output is sensible. Write down its objective, budget range and timeline in one sentence each.
3. Start with a deliberately vague prompt: 'Help me with my project.' Note how generic the answer is. This is your baseline.
4. Now apply the Persona pattern: 'Act as a stakeholder of the project. Perform an assessment of the project charter and provide a list of recommendations to improve scope clarity and completeness.' Compare against the baseline.
5. Apply the Flipped Interaction pattern so the AI interviews you: 'Ask me questions one at a time to prepare for a stakeholder update on [your project].' Answer at least five questions and note which gap it exposed.
6. Apply the Cognitive Verifier pattern to a complex question about your project - one that needs several sub-answers combined. Observe how it decomposes the question.
7. Apply the Fact Check List pattern to a question that depends on external industry data. Verify at least two of the sources it cites actually exist and say what it claims.

8. Record each prompt, the output and a one-line critique in your prompt library. Mark any output that was confidently wrong - this is the habit that protects you all course.

Check your work

Check: You have 10 prompts in your library, each with output and a critique, and you can state one concrete case where GenAI produced a plausible but wrong answer that you caught.

Remember: GenAI gives you a fast first draft. Check every figure, source and assumption before the output leaves your hands - you remain accountable for it.

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